

There were two things that they hadn't planned on. One was that Jackson's salary alone was too low to meet their minimum needs, regardless of how much they scrimped, and two was that the baby would have major health problems. Jordan was born with a form of spina bifida and required constant attention. The initial hospital bill was more than \$82,000, with their deductible portion being almost \$30,000.

Within six months of the baby's birth, they were in debt for nearly \$55,000 and sinking further behind every month. When they attempted to pay any portion of the doctor or hospital bills, they fell behind on payments for their monthly living expenses. If they tried to keep up on their living expenses, they fell behind on their medical bills.

By the seventh month some of the accounts had been turned over to collection agencies, and Linn was getting frequent, often rude calls at home. She was worn out, and saw her dreams of having a second child and maybe a third and then returning to teaching vanishing before her eyes. They couldn't make it with one, and his needs prevented her from even thinking about going back to work. Their pediatrician—a friend from church—suggested that they consider filing bankruptcy to relieve some of the financial pressure.

Coming home from the doctor's office Linn asked, "What did you think about what Doctor Yuan said?"

"I don't know. I've always believed that you should pay your bills, but that seems to be impossible in our case. Every month we get further behind. What do you think?"

"I don't know the answer either. But I do know I can't live under the kind of pressure I feel right now. We can't pay the doctor or hospital bills anyway, so I don't see what difference it would make if we file for bankruptcy. If we're ever able to pay, we can always start repaying the bills, can't we?"

"I guess so," Jackson replied. "I don't feel at peace about it, but I honestly don't know of another alternative. I'll call an attorney I know from the men's group and ask if he handles cases like these or